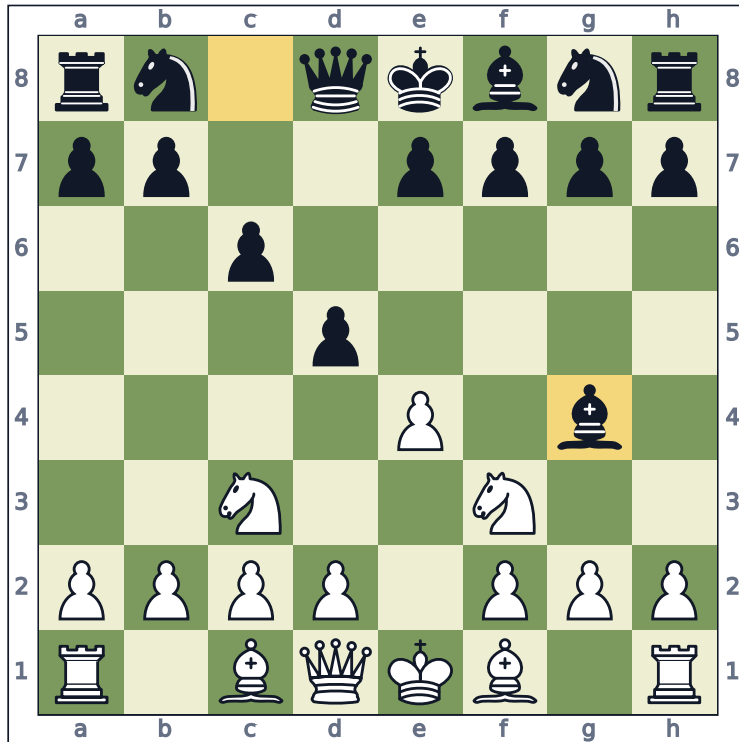


CARO-KANN DEFENSE

Caro-Kann Defense

ECO B11 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.52 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Active and tactical: both sides must calculate forcing moves before following a thematic plan.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B11 covers Caro-Kann Defense. Black supports ...d5 with ...c6, aiming for a sound center and a useful light-squared bishop. The diagram uses the featured line Caro-Kann Defense: Two Knights Attack, Mindeno Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Nf3 Bg4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use space and development, decide whether to advance or exchange on d5, and prevent Black's freeing breaks from coming easily.

BLACK'S GOALS

Develop the c8 bishop before closing it in, complete the structure, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 at the right moment.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's freeing breaks are ...c5 and ...e5; White may use c4, f4-f5, or a timely e6 push in advanced structures.

PIECE MAP

Black's light bishop is a strategic asset. White's knights often aim at e5, f5, and c5. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Black can become passive by defending the structure without arranging a freeing break. The word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c6, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of the best sound defenses to 1.e4, especially for players who value structure and endgame quality.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B11 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to B11 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Caro-Kann Defense: Two Knights Attack, Mindeno Variation

1. e4 c6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Nf3 Bg4

002 Caro-Kann Defense: Two Knights Attack, Mindeno Variation, Exchange Line

1. e4 c6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Nf3 Bg4 4. h3 Bxf3

003 Caro-Kann Defense: Two Knights Attack, Mindeno Variation, Retreat Line

1. e4 c6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Nf3 Bg4 4. h3 Bh5